

Verdant Peak Technologies - Employee Policies

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1. Introduction and Purpose

Verdant Peak Technologies (“VPT” or “the Company”) is committed to maintaining a fair, safe, and productive workplace for every employee. This Employee Policies document establishes the general rules, expectations, and standards that govern the employment relationship between VPT and its workforce. It applies to all full-time, part-time, contract, and temporary employees across all VPT offices, including Austin, Bengaluru, and Krakow. These policies work alongside the HR Handbook, Leave Policy, IT Policies, Travel Policy, Benefits Documentation, and Code of Conduct to provide a complete picture of what it means to work at VPT. Employees are expected to read, understand, and comply with these policies as a condition of continued employment.

2. Employment Classification

VPT classifies employees into the following categories: Regular Full-Time (working 40 hours per week and eligible for full benefits), Regular Part-Time (working fewer than 30 hours per week and eligible for prorated benefits), Fixed-Term Contract (engaged for a defined project or period, typically 6-24 months), and Interns (students or recent graduates engaged for a defined learning period, typically 3-6 months). Employment classification determines eligibility for benefits, leave accrual, and certain internal programs such as the Employee Stock Purchase Plan. Managers must confirm an employee’s classification with HR before making commitments regarding benefits or compensation.

3. Probationary Period

All new Regular Full-Time and Regular Part-Time employees serve a 90-day probationary period from their date of joining. During this period, the employee’s manager conducts at least two check-ins (at 30 and 60 days) to review performance and address any concerns. At the end of the 90 days, the manager submits a Probation Review Form to HR recommending confirmation, extension (up to an additional 30 days), or termination. Employees on probation remain eligible for statutory leave but are not eligible for the Referral Bonus Program or internal transfers until confirmed.

4. Working Hours and Attendance

Standard working hours at VPT are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM local time, Monday through Friday, with a one-hour unpaid lunch break, totaling 40 hours per week. Departments with operational needs (such as Customer Support and IT Operations) may operate on shift schedules, which will be communicated in writing by the relevant manager. Employees are expected to record their attendance daily through the VPT Time & Attendance Portal. Repeated unexplained absences (three or more in a rolling 30-day period) will trigger an automatic notification to the employee's manager and HR Business Partner for follow-up.

5. Flexible and Remote Work

VPT operates under a Hybrid Work Model. Employees are expected to be present in their assigned office location a minimum of three days per week (Tuesday, Wednesday, and Thursday are designated as Core Collaboration Days). The remaining two days may be worked remotely, subject to manager approval and role suitability. Fully remote arrangements may be granted on a case-by-case basis for employees with documented circumstances, approved jointly by the manager and HR. Remote work does not change an employee's obligations regarding working hours, data security, or availability during core hours (10:00 AM–4:00 PM local time).

6. Compensation and Payroll

Salaries are paid monthly, on the last working day of each month, via direct bank transfer. Payslips are made available electronically through the VPT Employee Self-Service (ESS) portal no later than three working days after payday. Any discrepancies in pay must be reported to the Payroll team within 15 calendar days of the pay date. VPT conducts an annual compensation review cycle each April, during which merit increases, promotions, and bonus payouts are evaluated based on performance ratings and market benchmarking. Overtime for non-exempt employees is compensated at 1.5 times the standard hourly rate for hours worked beyond 40 in a week, subject to prior manager approval.

7. Performance Management

VPT uses a continuous performance management framework built around quarterly check-ins and an annual formal review. Employees and managers jointly set goals using the OKR (Objectives and Key Results) framework at the start of each quarter. The annual review, conducted every March, results in a performance rating on a five-point scale (Exceptional, Exceeds Expectations, Meets Expectations, Needs Improvement, Unsatisfactory) that feeds into compensation decisions. Employees rated "Needs Improvement" or "Unsatisfactory" are placed on a Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) with clear milestones reviewed every 30 days.

8. Workplace Conduct and Anti-Harassment

VPT maintains a zero-tolerance policy toward harassment, discrimination, and retaliation of any kind, consistent with the Code of Conduct. All employees must complete mandatory Anti-Harassment

and Workplace Respect training within 30 days of joining and annually thereafter. Complaints may be raised confidentially through the Ethics Hotline, HR Business Partner, or direct manager. All complaints are investigated by the Employee Relations team within 10 working days, and retaliation against anyone who raises a good-faith concern is grounds for immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

9. Disciplinary Procedure

VPT follows a progressive discipline model consisting of Verbal Counseling, Written Warning, Final Written Warning, and Termination, though the Company reserves the right to skip steps in cases of serious misconduct (e.g., theft, harassment, data breaches, or falsification of records). Employees subject to disciplinary action have the right to a meeting with HR and their manager, may bring a colleague as a witness, and may appeal a decision in writing to the Employee Relations team within 10 working days of the decision.

10. Termination and Offboarding

Employees may resign by providing written notice per their employment contract (typically 30 or 60 days, depending on grade level). VPT may terminate employment for performance, conduct, or business reasons in accordance with local labor law and the employee's contract. All departing employees must complete the Offboarding Checklist, including return of Company assets, revocation of system access, and a mandatory exit interview with HR. Final settlement, including any accrued but unused leave payout, is processed within 45 days of the last working day.

11. Policy Review

These Employee Policies are reviewed annually by the HR Policy Committee and may be updated at any time to reflect changes in law or business needs. Employees will be notified of material changes via the internal HR portal and company-wide email at least 15 days before the change takes effect.